Nerd Nite Fort Collins

Be there and be square

You Had to be There

Justin Fritz

Boss, Nerd Nite Fort Collins



Nerd Nite Melbourne #71 • Howler, Brunswick • 14 October 2026

Hi. I'm Justin Fritz.

And I'm a Nerd Nite Boss.

That is a real title. They gave it to me. I take it very seriously.



I have had a lot of roles

Marine • navigator • instructor

chip designer • founder • host

As an American, I tend to conflate the person with the job.

Tonight I am here as myself.
And as a Nerd Nite boss.



The relevant education

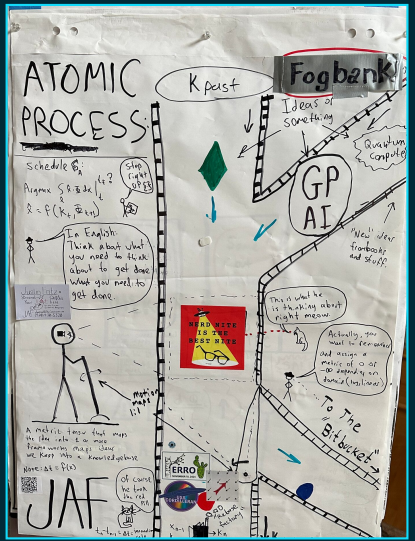
Not the classrooms.

In the field.

In the lab.

Frankly — at Nerd Nites.





Trajectories

Everything I just listed is a sampling of one trajectory.

Everyone in this room has a rich history.

Tonight ours came together here.

Thank you.

Nerd Nite Fort Collins

Talks. Mars. An abstract. An organ.



“You had to be there.”

when the description doesn’t carry the energy



Worst Party Ever

Everything You Didn’t Know About the Donner Party

Hannah Bauer

NNFC S2025E01 30 January 2025

Nobody at Wolverine Farm was in the Sierra Nevada in 1846.

For a moment they were.



Hector Berlioz Was a Visionary Composer and also a Creepy Stalker

Matt Browne

NNFC S2024E04 April 2024

Nerd Nite Fort Collins



You weren’t at the Donner Party.

You weren’t at the talk about the Donner Party.

You are at a talk about a talk about the Donner Party.

So why does it still work?





NASA/JPL-Caltech/MSSS · PIA19808

We have not sent people

We sent probes. Rovers. Instruments.

They returned more data than anyone can read.

Somebody had a hypothesis before it ever launched.

Somebody else is reading it back.

The data came back.
The people stayed home.

Energy does not transmit.



Worm Majix



John Anderson

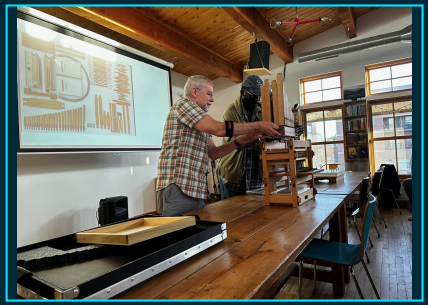
NNFC S2025E08 18 September 2025

The abstract arrived rough.

Jamie started to fix it.

I stopped her.

We ran it exactly as offered.



Let's Build a Pipe Organ!

Joel Bacon

NNFC S2026E06 18 June 2026

Hundreds of parts.

Two octaves. Hand pumped. Mechanical action.

The audience built it.

Then he played it

A hand-pumped organ cannot make a sound unless somebody is standing there supplying the air.

No person. No air.
No sound.

We needed a volunteer.

Somebody put their hand up.



Thank you

The talks I borrowed tonight

Hannah Bauer — *Worst Party Ever*
Fort Collins, Jan 2025

Matt Browne — *Hector Berlioz*
Fort Collins, Apr 2024

John Anderson — *Worm Majix*
Fort Collins, Sep 2025

Joel Bacon — *Let's Build a Pipe Organ!*
Fort Collins, Jun 2026

And whoever pumped the organ.

Everyone who makes this happen

Nerd Nite Melbourne — Ebony, Haylo and the bosses

Nerd Nite Fort Collins — Senne Van Loon,
Jamie Fritz, Hannah Bauer, Marybeth Arcodia

Chris Balakrishnan and **Matt Wasowski**, who started it in a bar in Boston

Bosses in 100+ cities, every month

Every speaker who ever trusted a room with the thing they love most.

And especially — all of you.